LESSON THREE

TPO PROFILE BASICS

Time at price: the letters, the POC, single prints, excess and poor extremes. The auction's fingerprint in time, and how to trade what it leaves behind.

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Ether, the free side of Ethos

Contents

This guide pairs with the video. **Watch it** for the live walkthrough, keep this next to the charts.

What a TPO profile is

Lesson 1 gave you the auction and Lesson 2 gave you volume at price. TPO is the other way to draw the same auction: time at price. Same theory, different fingerprint.

A TPO profile stacks letters. Each letter is one 30 minute period. The wider the row, the longer the market stayed there.

HOW THE LETTERS WORK

9:30 to 10:00 prints A, 10:00 to 10:30 prints B, and so on through the session. A price that keeps collecting letters is a price the auction keeps coming back to.

TPO VS VOLUME PROFILE

VP shows where the volume traded, TPO shows where the time was spent. Time and volume usually agree, and when they do not, that disagreement is information.

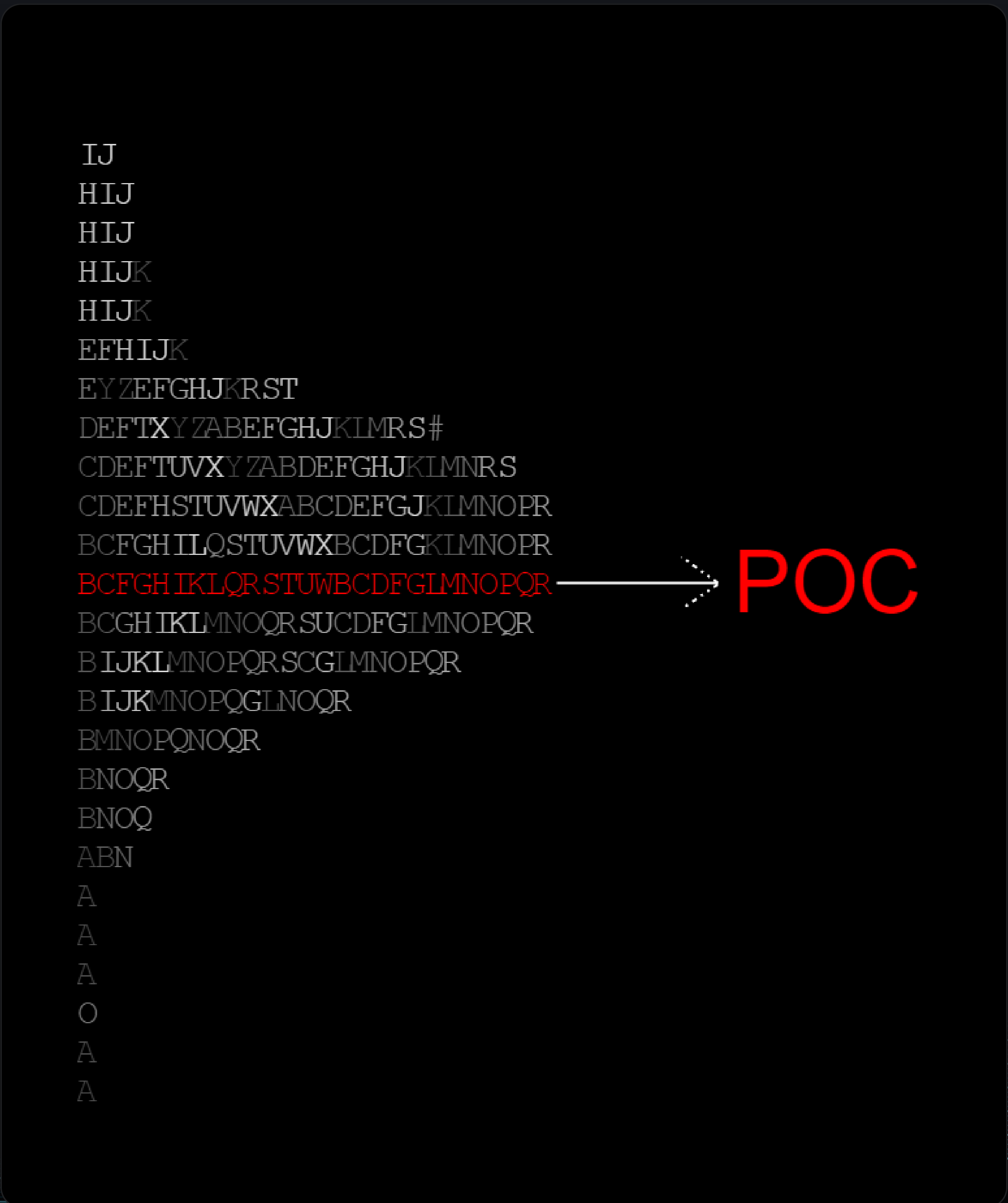
WHY TIME MATTERS

Time is how the market votes on fair value. Nobody spends three hours at a price they think is wrong.

POC, VAH and VAL in time

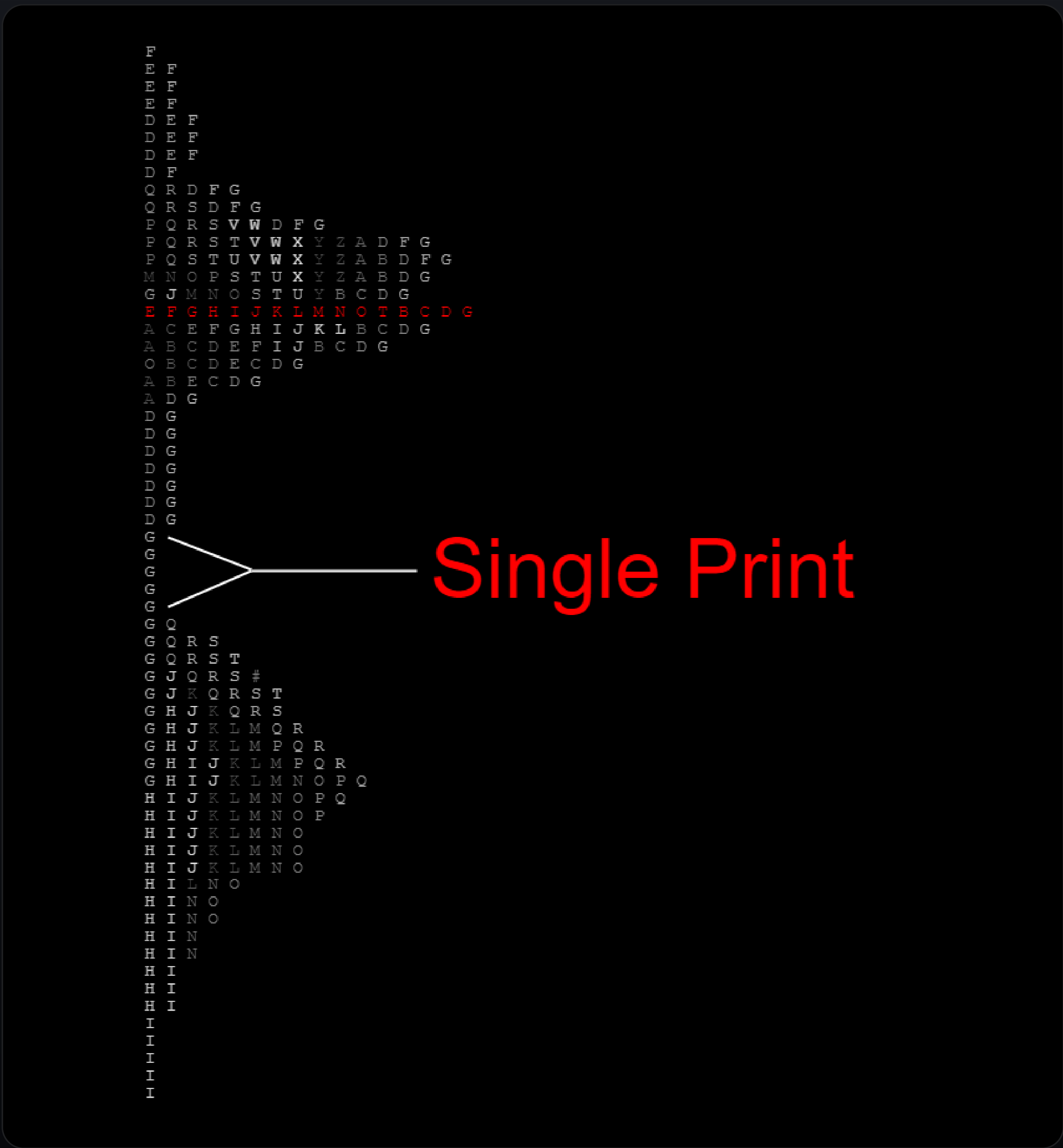
The same three levels from the volume profile exist here, built from time instead of volume.

POC	The price level with the highest amount of time spent. It acts as a draw for price, the level where buyers and sellers previously reached their fairest agreement.
VAH	Top of the value zone. Above it, price is trading at a premium.
VAL	Bottom of the value zone. Below it, price is trading at a discount.



Single prints

A single print is a single row of letters from one time period, with no overlap from any other period. Price moved through so fast that only one 30 minute window ever touched it.



Two single print examples on the profile: thin strips where only one letter ever printed.

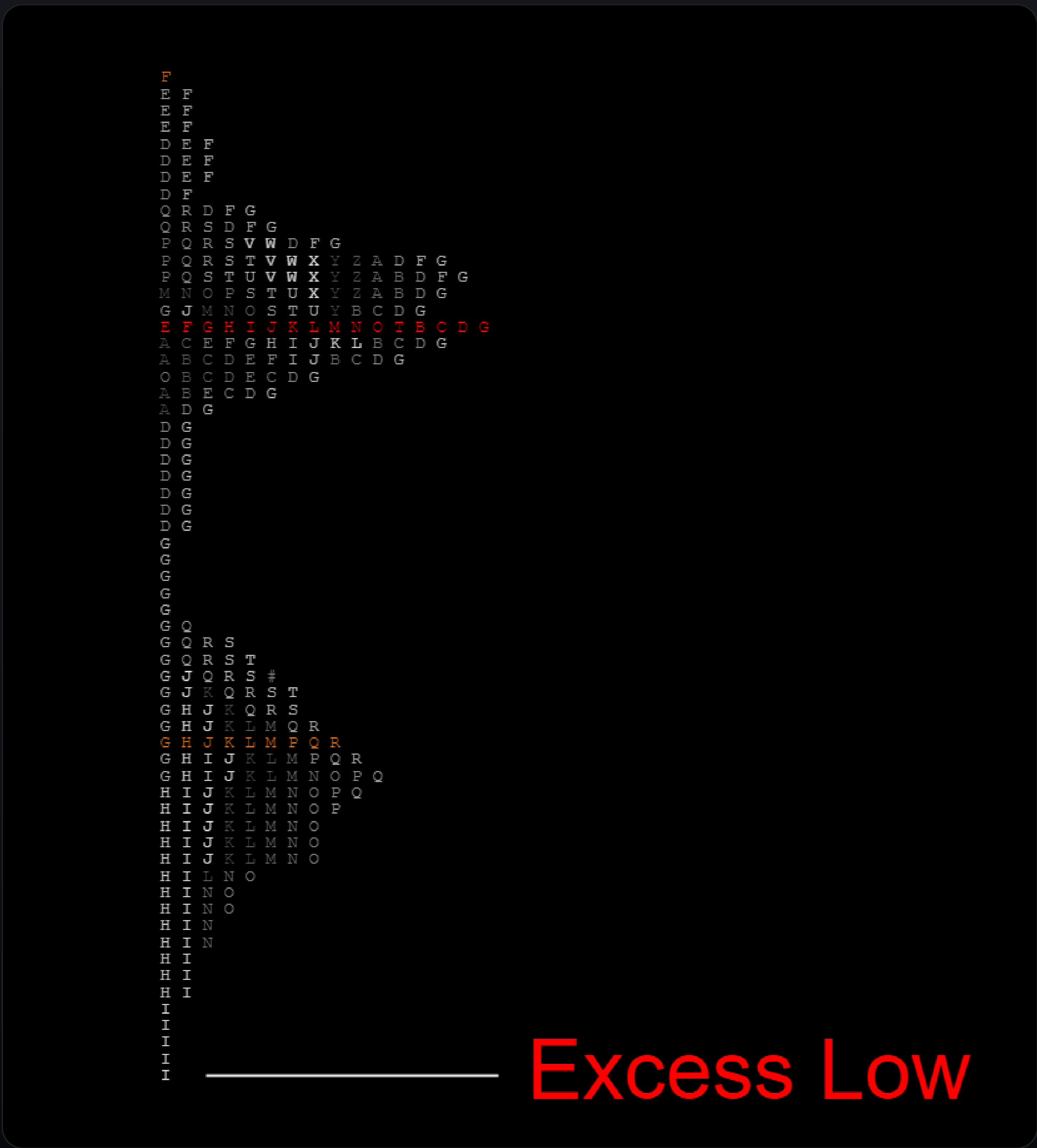
A single print is a sharp one sided move that leaves imbalance behind it. The market tends to come back and fill it, like a magnet.

HOW TO USE THEM

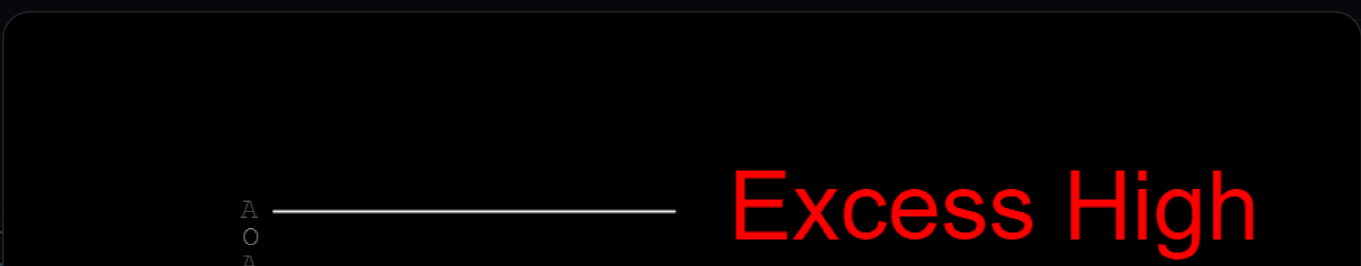
Mark fresh single prints as unfinished business. They are targets when price is moving toward them, and

Excess

Excess forms at the edges of a TPO profile, when two or more rows of the same letter print at the extreme. It is like a single print, but at the tails.



Excess at the edge of the profile: the same letter stacked at the extreme, then rejection.



Poor highs and poor lows

A poor high or poor low forms when the market shows weak rejection from a level, usually during probing moves. The extreme just stops, it never finishes.

A poor extreme on the profile: no tail, weak rejection, unfinished business the market tends to revisit.

ON NQ

Poor highs and lows usually appear as a single TPO tail and they are useful, NQ's thinner structure lets the probe print clean.

ON ES

The thicker market structure creates shorter, firmer tails. Poor extremes are less reliable on ES and rarely used, though they do appear.

Initial balance and range extension

The TPO chart hands you one more read the volume profile cannot: the initial balance, and what the market does to it.

The initial balance is the range of the first hour, the A and B periods. It frames the whole day.

RANGE EXTENSION

When a later period prints beyond the IB high or low, that is range extension. It signals one side has taken control and the day is trending out of balance.

IB HOLDS ALL DAY

If price stays inside the initial balance, the day is rotational, a normal or neutral day. Fade the IB edges back toward the POC.

IB BREAKS EARLY

An early, one sided range extension points at a trend day. Do not fade it, the auction has already decided.

WHY THE FIRST HOUR MATTERS

The IB is set by the participants who show up at the open with conviction. Whether the rest of the day respects it or breaks it tells you the day type before lunch, which is the same call the VIX and the open type give you, from a third angle.

The TPO checklist

Everything in this lesson is a reference the market itself left behind. The routine is the same as every level in the method.

- [x] **Mark the profile levels**
  POC, VAH, VAL from yesterday's TPO. Premium or discount is your first read of the day.

- [x] **List the unfinished business**
  Fresh single prints and poor extremes. These are the magnets, and your target list.

- [x] **Respect the finished business**
  Excess marks where an argument ended. Expect those extremes to hold on first test.

- [x] **Stack with the volume profile**
  TPO structure that lines up with a VP shelf or ledge is twice the level.

- [x] **Confirm at the level with the tape**
  DOM and footprint decide the entry. The profile is context, never the trigger.

Now read the time.

You can now read the auction in time as well as volume. Inside Ethos, the mentorship, you learn the KG models that trade these references, with live sessions three times a week.

- **Premium or discount first**
  Where is price relative to value? That is the opening read.
- **Magnets and finished business**
  Singles and poor extremes pull, excess holds.
- **Confirm with order flow**
  The profile is context, the tape is the trigger.

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